

EXCLUSIVE

IAS PRELIMS 2026

CURRENT AFFAIRS

REVISION

GS-1 (DYNAMIC)

MODULE - 20



**POLITY & OTHER
NATIONAL
EVENTS - 4**

WHAT WERE THE SALIENT FEATURES OF THE IWT?



The Government in April, 2025 said it would suspend the 1960 Indus Waters Treaty with Pakistan.

- The Treaty allocated the 3 western rivers - Indus, Chenab and Jhelum - to Pakistan for unrestricted use, barring certain non-consumptive, agricultural and domestic uses by India.
- The 3 Eastern rivers - Ravi, Beas and Sutlej - are to India for unrestricted usage.
- Hence 80% of the share i.e., 135 Million Acre Feet (MAF) went to Pakistan, leaving the rest 33 MAF or 20% of water for use by India.
- Under the IWT, India is permitted to store up to 3.6 million acre-feet (MAF) of water, develop 1.34 million acres of irrigation land in J&K and Ladakh and construct run-of-the-river dams on western rivers. However, India has a storage capacity of only around 1 MAF and has developed irrigation for about 0.642 million acres.
- India's hydroelectric projects on the Western rivers, such as the Kishanganga Hydroelectric Project, Ratle Dam, Salal Dam, Nimoo Bazgo and Baglihar dam do not have much storage capacities.
- Both the countries are required to establish a Permanent Indus Commission, constituted by Permanent Commissioners on both sides. It is the first stop for resolution of conflicts and expected to meet once in 6 months.

INDUS RIVER

HAVE A GLANCE AT INDUS RIVER SYSTEM!

TOTAL AREA OF INDUS BASIN:

11.65 lakh sq km

47% in Pakistan

39% in India,

8% in China,

6% in Afghanistan.

Source: India Water Resources Information system

PAKISTAN

CHINA

Tarbela Dam(Pak)

Mangla Dam(Pak)

Dul Hasti Hydroelectric Plant

Maharana Pratap Sagar Reservoir

Sengge Zangbo, Mount Kailash,
Near Manasarovar, Tibet, CHINA

Pong Dam

Nathpa Jhakri Dam

Gobind Sagar Reservoir

Baglihar Dam

Bhakra Dam

Salal Hydroelectric Power Station

Neither India nor Pakistan can unilaterally abrogate the Treaty. Article 12 of the Treaty says "The provisions of this Treaty shall continue in force until terminated by a duly ratified treaty concluded for that purpose between the two Governments."

PROCEDURE FOR SOLVING THE DISPUTES AS PER INDIA'S PERCEPTION

- The issues can first be resolved at the Commission or Inter-Governmental level.
- If that fails, either side can approach the World Bank to appoint a Neutral Expert (NE).
- If either party is still not satisfied, matters can be referred to a Court of Arbitration.



PAKISTAN OBJECTED TO ALMOST EACH RUN OF THE RIVER HYDRO POWER PROJECT!

- Pakistan has rights over the waters of Jhelum, Chenab and Indus, as already mentioned.
- However, Annexure D of the Treaty allows India to build 'run of the river' hydropower projects. The meaning is that these projects does not require live storage of water.
- There are also provisions for certain design specifications, which India is required to follow. Pakistan can also raise objections.
- India must share information on the project design with Pakistan, and if any, Pakistan respond with objections, within 3 months.



IN VIEW OF THE CONTINUED TUSSELE, INDIA WANTED TO MODIFY THE 62-YEAR-OLD IWT IN JANUARY, 2023!

- India in early 2023 wanted to modify the 62-year-old Treaty with Pakistan. India cited, what it called Pakistan's intransigence in resolving disputes over the Kishenganga and Ratle Hydro Power Projects, both in Jammu & Kashmir.
- India also protested Pakistan's unilateral decision to approach the court of arbitration at the Hague.
- The government had written to Pakistan calling for modifications to the treaty as per the Article XII (3) of the IWT that deals with the final provisions of the treaty. India requested for response from Pakistan within 90 days.

CAN INDIA ABROGATE THE TREATY UNILATERALLY?

- Although there is no explicit provision in the Treaty for its abrogation, Article 62 of the Vienna Convention on Law of the Treaties provides sufficient room under which the Treaty can be repudiated.
- This can happen because there is fundamental change in the circumstances which has occurred with regard to those existing at the time of conclusion of the Treaty.

EXPERTS QUESTION THE USAGE OF VIENNA CONVENTION IN REVOKING IWT

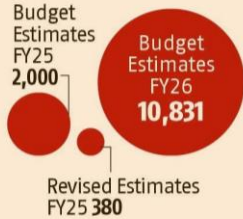
- Many Indian analysts often argue that the provisions under Articles 60 and 62 of the Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties (VCLT) can be used to revoke the Treaty.
- It is incidental to note that India is not a party to the VCLT and Pakistan has signed but not ratified it.
- Invoking the provisions under Article 62 of the VCLT on the IWT is convenient, but tough to argue.

Pakistan said that stopping water flow will be considered “an act of war”.



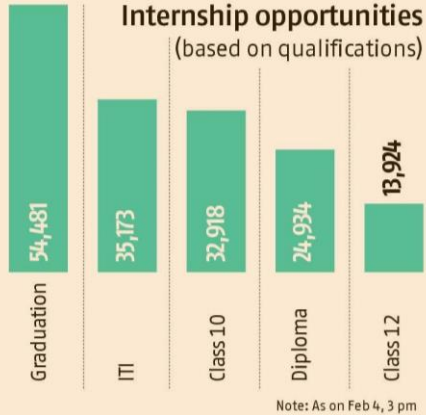
NUTS AND BOLTS

PM Internship Scheme (₹ crore)



Source: Budget documents

What's on offer?



- It offers 12 months of real-life experience in India's top companies, monthly assistance of Rs.4,500 is given by the Government of India and Rs. 500 is contributed by the industry.
- The government gives one time grant of Rs. 6,000 for incidentals to company.
- Insurance coverage for every intern will be under the Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana and Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana.
- The candidate must be an Indian citizen with age 21 to 24 years and not employed full time or engaged in full time education. Those enrolled in online or distance learning programs are eligible to apply.
- The eligibility about academic qualifications include SSC or HSE or ITI or diploma or graduation.

Why is Telangana in the news in the context of Sub-categorization of Scheduled Castes?



- Telangana became the first state to implement sub-categorization of Scheduled Castes - almost a year after the Supreme Court verdict that permitted states to sub-classify SCs and STs for the purpose of reservation.
- SCs and STs are not homogeneous communities and within the SCs, the relatively dominant castes have disproportionately reaped the benefits of affirmative action. Hukum Singh Commission in UP and the Sadashiva Commission in Karnataka highlighted the reality of intra-caste discrimination among the Dalits.
- The sub-categorization divides SCs into three categories and distributes the prevailing SC reservation of 15% among three groups - 1%, 9% and 5%.

11 states in the country have already adopted the principle of sub-classification within OBCs, based on socio-economic parameters. Sub-classification for SCs is acknowledgement of heterogeneity among Dalit communities.



- The Union Minister of Commerce and Industry inaugurated the National Turmeric Board. It is headquartered in Nizamabad, Telangana. It is a dedicated body established to promote turmeric cultivation, research and exports, ensuring holistic growth in the turmeric sector.
- Turmeric, *Curcuma longa* is a flowering plant belonging to the ginger family.
- It is a perennial rhizomatous herbaceous plant native to the Indian subcontinent and Southeast Asia. It is also known as the Golden Spice. It thrives in temperatures ranging between 20°C and 30°C with high annual rainfall.
- Turmeric farmers are spread across 20 states including Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Madhya Pradesh, among others.
- India cultivates 30 varieties that accounts for over 70% of global turmeric production. India has more than 62% share of World Trade. During 2023-24, 1.62 lakh tons of turmeric and turmeric products valued at around \$226 million was exported.

India is the largest producer, consumer and exporter of turmeric in the world.

What do you understand by Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC)?



- It is a transformative initiative by the DPIIT, Ministry of Commerce. It is aimed at democratizing digital commerce.
- It was launched in April 2022, aiming at promoting open networks for all aspects of exchange of goods and services over digital or electronic networks.
- It is based on open-sourced methodology, using open specifications and open network protocols independent of any specific platform.
- It intends to create a level playing field for sellers, buyers, and service providers across India, particularly small and medium enterprises (MSMEs).
- It was incorporated as a non-profit, Section-8 company and incubated at the Quality Council of India. QCI was joined by Protean as the co-founder for incorporation of ONDC.
- With an additional authorized capital of Rs. 500 crore, many public and private banks and financial institutions have contributed equity to ONDC.

It intends to break the dominance of large e-commerce platforms by enabling interoperability across networks. It empowers small businesses such as retailers and local artisans to access the digital marketplace.

What do you know about the Crime and Criminal Tracking Network and Systems (CCTNS) and Integrated Criminal Justice System (ICJS)?

The scope of the CCTNS has been enhanced over the years to integrate the police data with other pillars of the criminal justice system namely courts, prisons, prosecution, forensics and finger-prints. It is called the Integrated Criminal Justice System (ICJS).



- CCTNS is a centralized online platform to file First Information Reports (FIRs), charge sheets and investigation reports. The online database can be accessed by law enforcement authorities across the country. Nearly 15 years after it was launched, all 17,130 police stations in the country have been linked through the CCTNS.
- The system has past and current crime records, including details of the accused, charge-sheeted persons, convicts, habitual offenders, proclaimed offenders, and others.
- The NCRB has made 23 functional modifications in the existing CCTNS application for the three criminal laws:
 - ✓ Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita that replaced the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
 - ✓ Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam that replaced the Indian Evidence Act, 1872.
 - ✓ Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita that replaced the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898.

What do you know about the recent controversy around the excavations at Keezhadi (Keeladi)?



- Excavations at Keezhadi have revealed the existence of an advanced urban settlement, possibly going back as far as the 8th to the 5th Century BCE.
- The findings - which include evidence of trade, such as carnelian beads, and literacy, in the form of Tamil-Brahmi inscriptions on potsherds - paint a compelling picture of a flourishing civilization in South India dating back much further than previously believed.
- However, this report is into controversy as the Union Culture Minister raised questions over the 989-page final report submitted in 2023. The concerned Archaeologist was transferred.

What do you know about the visit of the Prime Minister to Gangaikonda Cholapuram?



- The Prime Minister visited Gangaikonda Cholapuram and addressed at the annual Aadi Thiruvathirai festival. It is to mark the birth anniversary of Rajendra Chola.
- Emperor Rajendra Chola-I built Gangaikonda Cholapuram along with the Brihadisvara Temple and the Chola Ganga (also known as Ponneri), a massive lake, after his victorious expedition to the Gangetic plains about 1,000 years ago.
- The Prime Minister announced the installation of grand statues of the monarchs Raja Raja Chola and his son Rajendra Chola in Tamil Nadu.
- The Prime Minister also released a commemorative coin in honour of the King. Chola rule is known for its water management, tax and land revenue collection and democratic processes.

Raja Raja Chola built a powerful Navy, his son Rajendra Chola once strengthened it. They extended diplomatic and trade relations to Sri Lanka, The Maldives, The Southeast Asia.



- Zojila Tunnel Project connects Baltal in Kashmir's Ganderbal District to Minimarg in Drass in Ladakh.
- The bi-directional tunnel is expected to open for emergency and defense use by December 2025, with the full completion projected by December 2027.
- The tunnel is 13 KM long and it is India's highest highway tunnel at 12,000 feet.
- Once operational, the 31 KM route - including an 18 KM approach road - will provide critical crucial connectivity between Kashmir and Ladakh, facilitating winter travel and military access.

It was approved at a cost of Rs. 6,800 crore and it is part of a broader infrastructure initiative to enhance regional connectivity with 31 tunnels planned across J&K and Ladakh.



- Discussions about instituting a prestigious award for exceptional literary works in Indian languages first began in 1961, on the occasion of the 50th birthday of Sahu Shanti Prasad Jain, an Indian industrialist and the founder of Bharatiya Jnanpith. The first award was given in 1965. It is sponsored by the cultural organization Bharatiya Jnanpith.
- This is considered the highest literary award in India, given annually for the best creative literary output to writers in any of the 22 languages recognized by the Constitution of India and, from 2013, in the English language.
- The prize carries a cash award of Rs. 11 lakh, a citation, and a bronze replica of Vagdevi (Saraswati), the goddess of learning.
- The award has typically been given every year to one author, although in some years it has been jointly offered to two.
- The Award is given for lifetime contribution to Indian literature since 1982.

G. Sankara Kurup received the first Jnanpith Award for his contributions to Malayalam literature. In 1976, Bengali author Asha Purna Devi became the first woman to win the prize. At 88 years, Vinod Kumar Shukla is the first writer from Chhattisgarh, who won the Jnanpith Award for 2024.



- The Central Government launched the National Rural Health Mission in 2005 and nominated ASHA's to be the link between community and the public healthcare delivery system.
- Now, there are over a million ASHA's across the country and each one is firmly ensconced as the fulcrum of public health care in their area of operation in rural India.
- They perform full complement of functions like:
 - ✓ Recording birth and death data.
 - ✓ Implementing interventions in non-communicable diseases and communicable diseases, neglected tropical diseases.
 - ✓ Serving as a crucial reproductive, maternal, newborn child and adolescent health role.
 - ✓ Monitoring health, hygiene and sanitation in the community.

ASHA's played a crucial role during the COVID-19 pandemic as health care workers trusted by the community. They were chosen for the WHO Director General's Global Health Leaders Award in 2022 and were recognized for their outstanding contribution towards protecting and promoting health.

What are the problems faced by the ASHA workers?



- The designation is the real problem as they are designated as volunteers since inception. They remained eligible only for a meager fixed salary from the Centre.
- Rest of the compensation is provided as an incentive (shared by the Center and States) against a deliverable - for instance, for facilitating an institutional birth.
- As per Estimates, an ASHA worker can make anything between Rs. 5,000 and Rs. 15,000 per month.
- In 2018, the government approved an ASHA benefit package providing coverage for accidents, deaths and disability.
- They work long hours, travel long distances, frequently miss meals and have little time to take care of their own health needs.

As per analysts, adequate compensation and emoluments should be given to them, commensurate with their workload or they should be treated as permanent employees.



- The Vizhinjam International transshipment deepwater multipurpose seaport is an ambitious project undertaken by the Government of Kerala.
- It is designed primarily to cater to container transshipment besides multi-purpose and break-bulk cargo.
- It is developed in landlord model with a Public Private Partnership components on a Design, Build, Finance, Operate, and Transfer (DBFOT) basis.
- The idea is to make it the preferred international transshipment gateway on the Indian subcontinent.

The viability gap funding for the project is given by the Central Government.

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